CalWORKs Program Guide: A. Expanded Subsidized Employment Program

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 10-150: SUBSIDIZED EMPLOYMENT
TITLE: A. EXPANDED SUBSIDIZED EMPLOYMENT (ESE) PROGRAM

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE

The Expanded Subsidized Employment (ESE) program provides wage subsidies to public, non-profit, or private-sector employers to create immediate paid employment opportunities for CalWORKs Welfare-to-Work (WTW) participants, facilitating hands-on work experience, skill acquisition, and permanent job retention under California Welfare and Institutions Code Section 11322.63.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & WAGE SUBSIDIES

? Wage Subsidies: San Diego County HHSA provides subsidies covering a percentage of the participant's gross wages and associated payroll taxes for up to 6 months, with optional extension up to 12 months when retention criteria are demonstrated.

? Real Wages & Benefits: ESE participants are genuine employees of the hiring organization and receive the prevailing wage (at or above statutory minimum wage) along with all workplace protections, workers' compensation, and applicable employment benefits.

? CalWORKs Grant Budgeting: Because ESE wages are earned income, the CalWORKs assistance unit benefits from the statutory $450 earned income disregard plus 50% disregard on remaining wages, allowing families to receive a partial cash grant while working.

? Core Work Participation: All paid hours in ESE count 100% toward federal and state core work participation rate requirements.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

? Employer Master Agreement: Confirm execution of the County ESE Master Employer Agreement establishing wage reimbursement schedules and employer commitment to retain the employee upon subsidy conclusion.

? Payroll Tracking: Verify monthly earnings through electronic payroll records or paystubs, recalculating the family's cash grant accordingly.

? Transition to Unsubsidized Work: Coordinate job coaching and supportive services during months 4 through 6 to facilitate seamless retention as a permanent, unsubsidized employee.